

Nunes Dairy, Clay Tile Silo
9854 Bruceville Road
Elk Grove
Sacramento County
California

HABS No. CA-2713-B

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PHOTOGRAPHS

WRITTEN HISTORICAL AND DESCRIPTIVE DATA

Historic American Buildings Survey
National Park Service
Department of the Interior
San Francisco, California

HISTORIC AMERICAN BUILDING SURVEY

NUNES DAIRY, Clay Tile Silo

HABS No. CA-2713-B

- Location: 9854 Bruceville Road
Elk Grove
Sacramento County, California
- USGS Florin, California, Quadrangle (7.5'), Universal Transverse Mercator coordinates: 10.637820.4250990
- Significance: This silo is distinctive in its design and construction material. The use of hollow clay tiles is unusual for the Central California region and appears unique in the Elk Grove area. In contrast, most of the surviving silos in the local area were constructed of concrete rings bound together with iron bands.
- Description: The silo is approximately 40 feet high. It is constructed of square red clay hollow tiles marked by a thin vertical line pattern. On the north side of the tower there is an enclosed metal rung ladder. The roof is conical. The tiles of the upper quarter of the structure are lighter than those below and indicate that construction proceeded in two stages. The structure is in good condition with no obvious additions.
- The structure was demolished in 2001.
- Historical Context: This storage structure was built on the Johnston Ranch by local labor in 1916. The design of the silo was taken from similar structures on Moringdale's Ranch near Stockton. The tiles were manufactured by H.C. Muddox. The silo was originally constructed as a pump house.
- Sources: Johnston, Milon. Interview with Ric Windmiller, Elk Grove, California, 18 January 2001.
- Project Information: This project was undertaken to mitigate the effects of placing 1,000 housing units on the ranch site and demolishing all the existing ranch buildings. The City of Elk Grove, under provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act, required the developer, Forecast Homes of Sacramento, to initiate mitigation before allowing construction to begin. Ric Windmiller, M.A.,

Consulting Archaeologist, supervised the project. Dan Osanna, M.A., prepared part of the text. Donald S. Napoli, Ph.D., edited and completed the text. Robert A. Hicks, Field Documentation Service, prepared the photographs. The project was completed in May 2002.